# Digital Discourse: Analysis of Sentiments and Themes in Reddit Discussions on the Palestine-Israel Conflict

Anonymous ACL submission

## Abstract

This paper provides a detailed examination of Reddit discussions on the Israel-Palestine conflict through various analytical techniques, including sentiment analysis, topic modeling via LDA, and linear regression. It uncovers how sentiment and thematic content vary across different subreddits, shedding light on unique community-specific viewpoints. The research demonstrates that the specific subreddit in which discussions are held significantly impacts comment visibility and engagement, as indicated by varied patterns of upvotes. This investigation enhances our comprehension of online discourse regarding complex geopolitical issues and highlights the potential biases in analyzing user-generated content on social media.

## 1 Introduction

The conflict between Palestine and Israel has always been an ongoing political problem which can be retroactive to the Arab-Israeli War back in 1948, during which 200,000 Arabs were displaced by Israel into Gaza, either fleeing or expelled by Israel. This long-standing dispute has had a grave human toll, with 6,407 Palestinians and 308 Israelis killed prior to the 2023 Israel-Hamas conflict (Wikipedia, 2024a,d).

The rise of social media has accelerated the spread of information globally, amplifying voices from both sides of the conflict. This has led to a surge in online solidarity movements, with individuals around the world participating in demonstrations either in support of Palestine or Israel, especially since the Israeli military operation in Gaza that began on October 27 (Wikipedia, 2024b). These demonstrations often lead to the arrest of protesters (The Guardian, 2024; BBC, 2024), intensifying social unrest and underscoring the profound divisions and strong emotions stirred by the conflict. The frequent arrests not only highlight the contentious nature of the issue but also reflect the passionate responses it evokes from people involved on both sides.

This paper seeks to explore a way to understand public discourse on complex and sensitive geopolitical issues by analyzing the way they are presented by both parties on public forums, namely Reddit comments on the Palestine and Israel conflict. By extracting and analyzing text data from Reddit, the study aims to understand how digital discourse influences public demonstrations and to discern any differences in the narratives of the two advocacy groups.

## 2 Methods

The project contains the process of text data collection using Reddit Extractor in R Studio[1], text data cleaning, text mining techniques, sentiment analysis and applications of machine learning algorithms.

### 2.1 Data Collection

To understand the varying public sentiments on the Palestine/Israel conflict, conflict-related text data is collected from Reddit, a dynamic, open social media platform with over 267 million weekly active users as of December 2023, characterized by user-generated communities known as subreddits. Each subreddit is dedicated to a specific topic, ranging from broad themes like news and science to niche interests. On Reddit, users who have created accounts can post content, and participate in moderation through upvotes and downvotes (Reddit, 2024). The platform's unique structure allows users to create self-governing, self-organized

| Source | Subscribers | #Threads | #Comments | TTR Before | TTR After |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| r/Palestine | 230,788 | 640 | 9,872 | 0.86 | 0.97 |
| r/Israel | 219,291 | 754 | 32,206 | 0.86 | 0.95 |
| By keywords | NA | 244 | 95,605 | 0.84 | 0.94 |
| **Total** | | **1,638** | **137,683** | | |

Table 1: Number of threads extracted from selected sub-reddits and from keywords searching, with the average TTR before and after pre-processing

subreddits, offering both anonymity and public visibility. This makes Reddit distinct from other social networks and also acts as a social news site, where interaction primarily occurs through original posts, external links, and comments on threads in various subreddits such as /r/AskReddit (Lister et al., 2008).

Data extraction is performed using the 'RedditExtractoR' package (Rivera, 2023) in R Studio. While only registered users have the ability to create posts on Reddit, the majority of subreddits are publicly accessible to visitors who do not have user profiles or do not actively participate in the subreddit (Eysenbach and Till, 2001). As a result, the number of individuals who view subreddits often exceeds the number of subscribed community members. This characteristic of Reddit allows for a broader audience to engage with content, even if they do not contribute directly by posting or commenting, making researching on the platform more valuable, providing insights into public opinions and discussions surrounding contentious issues like the Palestine/Israel conflict.

Contents on Reddit follow an organized structure, a subreddit, a thread/post within the subreddit and comments within each thread. Therefore, the first objective is to obtain sufficient URLs of the thread we are interested in. Due to the scraping limit on Reddit, a hybrid approach is used to obtain comprehensive threads that could be relevant to our study:

1. Extract hot posts in the past month from relevant top-subscribed subreddit

2. Extract relevant posts using keywords searching across all subreddits

The number of threads found is displayed in Table 1. A total number of 1638 threads are extracted between 30th March to 30th April, which provides 137,683 comments.

### 2.2 Pre-processing

Pre-processing is an important step to remove noise before analysis, first we remove punctuations, numbers and symbols, ensuring that only textual content is analyzed and that the text is uniform for subsequent steps. The next step involves removing hyperlinks from the text, which is achieved using a regular expression designed to recognize most URL formats. This is crucial because URLs generally do not add meaningful content to natural language processing and can distort text analysis outcomes. Removing these links ensures cleaner data, leading to more accurate interpretations and analyses. Next, we remove stop words, which are typically words that do not carry significant meaning, such as 'the', 'is', and 'at'. Eliminating these words from the text allows the analysis to focus on more meaningful words that are likely to convey the unique content and context of the text. This step helps in understanding the data for more effectively and precisely. All remaining text is then converted to lowercase to ensure that the analysis is conducted using same case, which means that words such as 'Apple', 'apple', and 'APPLE' are treated as the same word.

### 2.3 Type-token-ratio

The average type-token-ratio (TTR) score for each data source before and after pre-processing is displayed in Table 1, which is a well-known measure of lexical diversity calculated as:

$$TTR = \frac{Number\ of\ Types}{Number\ of\ Tokens} \quad (1)$$

A higher TTR indicates a richer, more diverse vocabulary within a text, characterized by a larger proportion of unique words relative to the total word count. Conversely, a lower TTR suggests that the text is more repetitive, featuring fewer unique

| | r/Palestine | r/Israel | Others |
|---|---|---|---|
| Min. | -3.40 | -3.40 | -3.40 |
| 1st Qu. | 4.45 | 4.45 | 5.56 |
| Median | 7.72 | 7.59 | 8.40 |
| Mean | 8.68 | 8.43 | 9.27 |
| 3rd Qu. | 11.13 | 10.39 | 11.37 |
| Max. | 539.40 | 480.40 | 457.19 |

Table 2: Descriptive statistics of Flesch-Kincaid readability scores across subreddits

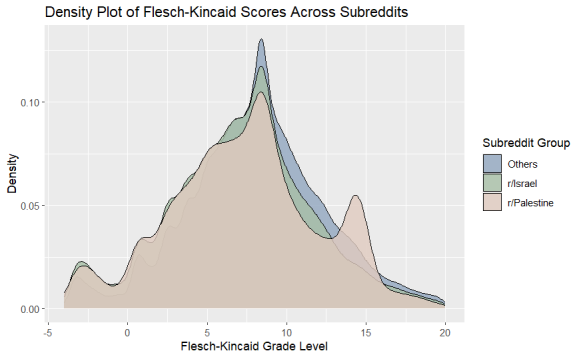



Figure 1: A density plot of Flesch Kincaid Grade Level score between -4 and 20 for three data sources

words that are used more frequently. From Table 1 we could conclude that comments from the Palestine sub-community have the highest TTR, however, TTR is sensitive to the length of the text, and low TTR might be caused by very long comments.

### 2.4 Readability

Readability metrics have been extensively studied and applied in various fields such as communication (Gunning, 1969), education, and informatics, including the analysis of social media writing (Todwal and Wanjari, 2015). These metrics offer quantitative estimates of how easily readers can understand a piece of written text, providing valuable insights for improving text clarity and engagement across different domains.

Flesch Kincaid Grade Level (Solnyshkina et al., 2017) score for each comment is calculated using the formula below, then descriptive statistics is shown in Table 2.

$$FKGL = 0.39 \times \frac{total\ words}{total\ sentences} + 11.8 \times \frac{total\ syllables}{total\ words} - 15.59 \quad (2)$$

We could see the mean readability score for comments are 8.68, 8.43 and 9.27 for different data sources, which is approximately 8th, 9th-grade school level. Comments using keyword searching have 9.27 average score, which can be justified due to more complex words from more professional sub-community like r/politics and r/worldnews.

The readability score within most score range is visualized in Figure 1, where most posts have a score of around 8, which corresponds to the philosophy/religion sub-reddit from another research by Tsou (2016), and comments from the Palestine sub-community have another peak around a score of 14, indicating a more advanced language use.

### 2.5 Linear Regression

A question follows is whether the same topic on Palestine/Israel conflict would have different upvotes based on different subreddit the comment is made in, and whether readability score and TTR would affect the upvotes that comment receive.

$$Upvotes = \beta_0 + \beta_1 * Readability + \beta_2 * Group_{Israel} + \beta_3 * Group_{Palestine} + \beta_4 * TTR + \epsilon \quad (3)$$

where:

- $\beta_0$ is the intercept.
- $\beta_1$ is the coefficient for the readability score.
- $\beta_2$ and $\beta_3$ are coefficients for belonging to the subreddits Israel and Palestine respectively, with Others being the baseline group .
- $\beta_4$ is the coefficient for the Type-Token Ratio.
- $\epsilon$ represents the model error.

### 2.6 Weighted Term-Frequency by Upvotes

Term frequency (TF) counts the frequency of each term in each document, which is commonly used to quantify the significance of a word in the context of text analysis and natural language processing. Additionally, weighting terms based on upvotes shifts the emphasis from simple frequency of occurrence to contextual significance. Terms that frequently appear in highly upvoted comments are given more importance, indicating that these terms are especially valuable to the community. This approach

helps highlight the words and concepts that truly capture the attention and approval of the audience under the same topic from the three data sources we are interested, it is calculated as:

$$Weighted{-}tf(t,d) = tf(t,d) * upvotes(d) \quad (4)$$

where:

- tf(t,d) is the term frequency of t in document d
- upvotes(d) is the upvotes of the document d

TF-IDF scaling method is not used since we are trying to reveal the most representative terms under the topic of the Palestine/Israel conflict from different subreddit, we are not trying to highlight terms that are uniquely significant within particular comments.

### 2.7 Sentiment Analysis

Sentiment analysis, often known as opinion mining, involves the statistical categorization of texts based on sentiment or emotion by assigning numeric values to them. This process allows for the quantitative assessment of feelings expressed in written content, making it possible to gauge the overall sentiment or emotional tone of a dataset systematically (Rani and Kumar, 2017).

Researchers tend to focus on sentiment analysis at the word level and aim to extract valuable insights from the basic units of communication within a text. By examining single words, often researchers can gain information beyond the sentiment, such as the demographic characteristics of the users, which can provide deeper insights into the context and the perspectives of the commenter. This approach helps to enrich the understanding of how different groups may express sentiments under the Palestine/Israel topic that we are interested in (Yue et al., 2019).

We use function from "syuzhet" package with SemEval-2015 English Twitter Sentiment Lexicon (Mohammad and Kiritchenko, 2015) to generate an overall sentiment score for each Reddit comment as text input, where a score between -1 and 1 would be assigned to each token, and the overall score is the sum of these individual scores. The sentiment lexicon has proven to be useful for analyzing comments on Twitter (Rosenthal et al., 2015; Svetlana Kiritchenko and Mohammad, 2014), demonstrating its applicability and effectiveness, which could suggest that the lexicon could also be applied to comments on Reddit. The text pre-processing is carried out again using the "stringr" package, following the methods described in section 2.2. However, this time, we retain the stop words, as retaining these can be critical for maintaining the emotional context of the text, as explained in Hill (2021). Many stop-word lists, including the default ones for English, actually contain words that carry sentiment. Since our analysis involves matching terms to a sentiment lexicon, removing these stop words could inadvertently eliminate important sentiment-bearing words. Therefore, there is no benefit in removing stop words for this specific purpose, as it might lead to a loss of valuable sentiment data in the analysis.

### 2.8 Topic Modelling and Geopolitical Stance Prediction

Topic modelling is an unsupervised machine-learning algorithm that identifies clusters or groups of similar words within a body of text (Murakami et al., 2017). Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA) is a widely used technique for topic modeling, which operates on the principle that documents are composed of a blend of topics, where each topic is itself a collection of words. It examines the relationships and patterns among words within documents to group them into distinct topics (Tong and Zhang, 2016).

To effectively analyze the themes within the comments, we use Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA) to extract potential themes from all comments. We then manually review the themes identified by the topic model to ensure they are relevant to the desired categories, ideally we could have themes that are relevant to Palestine or Israel. Then we assign each comment to one of those identified themes (Palestine or Israel) by calculating the posterior probability that a comment belongs to a specific theme. This statistical approach ensures that comments are categorized based on their content's likelihood to discuss certain topics. Last, we combine sentiment analysis with theme assignment to specify the geopolitical stance of each comment:




Figure 2: Word cloud of weighted term frequencies for comments from (a)r/Israel, (b)r/Palestine, (c)Others

- If the sentiment score is negative, classify the comment as opposing the conflict, regardless of the theme
- If the sentiment score is highly positive and the theme is relevant to Palestine, classify the comment as Pro-Palestine
- If the sentiment score is highly positive and the theme is relevant to Israel, classify the comment as pro-Israel
- All other comments

## 3 Results

A results section presenting findings with appropriate evaluation metrics.

### 3.1 Linear Regression

$$Upvotes = 6.06 - 0.02 \times Readability + 5.13 \times \mathrm{I}_{Israel} + 10.80 \times I_{Palestine} + 2.42 \times TTR + \epsilon \quad (5)$$

where:

- I is the indicator variable for subreddit Israel or Palestine

The linear regression results shown in Table 3 is displayed as Equation 5, illustrating that with all other variables being equal, comments in Israel and Palestine sub-reddit has significantly higher expected upvotes of 5.13 and 10.80 than comments respectively from other sub-reddit with both p<0.001, indicating a higher level of engagement or interest in these particular sub-reddit groups than in the others. Model also shows that the readability score and TTR score do not have a significant effect on the expected upvotes.

| | Coefficient | Std.Error | t-stat | P-value |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Intercept | 6.06 | 1.83 | 3.31 | < 0.001 *** |
| Readability | -0.02 | 0.02 | -1.14 | 0.26 |
| r/Israel | 5.13 | 0.36 | 14.16 | < 0.001 *** |
| r/Palestine | 10.80 | 0.59 | 18.18 | < 0.001 *** |
| TTR | 2.42 | 1.89 | 1.28 | 0.20 |

Table 3: Results of the linear regression model

Given the high F-statistic (119.5 on 4 and 136565 DF) and the extremely low p-value (< 2.2e-16), the model statistically significantly predicts the number of upvotes. However, the adjusted $R^2$ is only 0.35%, meaning only that amount of variation of upvotes is explained by the model's inputs. This low adjusted R-squared value suggests that there are many other factors influencing upvotes that are not included in the model.

### 3.2 Weighted Term-Frequency by Upvotes

As illustrated in Figure 2, weighted term frequency is visualized using word clouds. These clouds display terms from each source, with their size indicating the frequency and the degree of upvotes is also considered. Larger words represent a higher occurrence, and the most frequent term is displayed in the darkest purple. Under consistent settings across each plot, terms from r/Palestine show a richer vocabulary, aligning with its high Type-Token Ratio (TTR) noted in Table 1.

Some interesting patterns can be observed, for example, the terms 'Palestine' and 'genocide' are notably dominant in the Palestine subreddit but are not as prevalent in the other two sources, despite the same topic being discussed. This discrepancy highlights how different communities may focus

on or emphasize different aspects of a topic, reflecting distinct perspectives or priorities within each group.

### 3.3 Sentiment Analysis

The density plot depicted in Figure 3 illustrates the distribution of sentiment scores across comments. The summary statistics provided in the top left corner of the plot reveal that most comments have sentiment scores clustering around 0, indicating a neutral sentiment. However, the plot also highlights the presence of some comments with extreme sentiment scores, ranging from a minimum of -26.45, reflecting highly negative sentiments, to a maximum of 21.90, indicating strongly positive sentiments.

Some examples of comments with extreme sentiment scores are displayed in Table 4 and Table 5 in Appendix A. Comments with extremely positive or negative sentiments tend to contain a large number of words. This suggests that the length of a comment may significantly impact its cumulative sentiment score, with longer comments potentially amplifying the overall sentiment value, whether positive or negative. To address this issue of extreme sentiment scores, we have refined our classification approach. Comments are now categorized into three sections: "Neutral", "Positive", and "Negative". The classification is based on the following criteria:

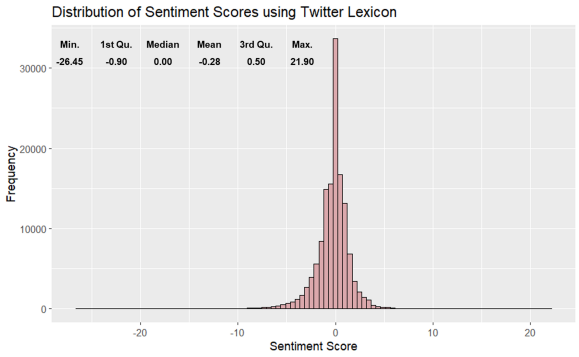



Figure 3: Density plot showing the distribution of sentiment scores using the Twitter lexicon with summary statistics

- Neutral: Sentiment scores ranging between -0.5 and 0.5
- Positive: Sentiment scores greater than or equal to 0.5
- Negative: Sentiment scores less than or equal to -0.5

This approach allows for a more valuable distinction between the sentiments expressed in the comments by handling extreme values, helping to better capture the overall mood and tone conveyed by the users.

Overall, there are 33% of the comments is classified as negative, 25% classified as positive and 42% as neutral. Percentages of sentiment category within each subreddit are visualized in Figure 4, where a high percentage of negative comments was observed within the Palestine community and other communities discussing the Palestine/Israel conflict topic.

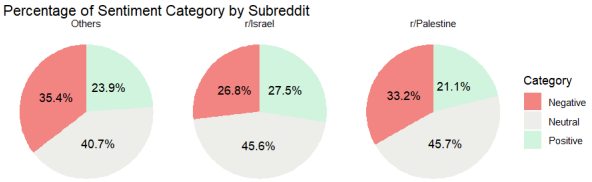



Figure 4: Pie charts of the percentage of sentiment category for each subreddit

By classifying comments into sentiment categories, we can visualize the distribution of these categories over time. As depicted in Figure 5, there is a noticeable peak in sentiment activity at the beginning of April, with a pronounced surge in negative sentiment. This spike correlates with significant events in the region, specifically the Israeli raid on al-Shifa Hospital from March 18 to April 1. This period of heightened negative sentiment also coincides with the aftermath of an Israeli airstrike on April 1st, which tragically resulted in the deaths of seven aid workers from the World Central Kitchen, including nationals from Britain, Poland, Australia, and Ireland (Wikipedia, 2024c).

### 3.4 Topic Modelling

By training the LDA model with k=4, we can compute the beta values and sort the top 10 important words to each topic as shown in Figure 6. By manually checking each topic, topic 4 could be related to pro-Palestine since it relates to strong terms like "genocide", and topic 3 could be related to pro-Israel. After assigning a topic to each comment, the geopolitical stance for each comment is classified using sentiment score and the latent topic it belongs to, results are shown in Figure 7.

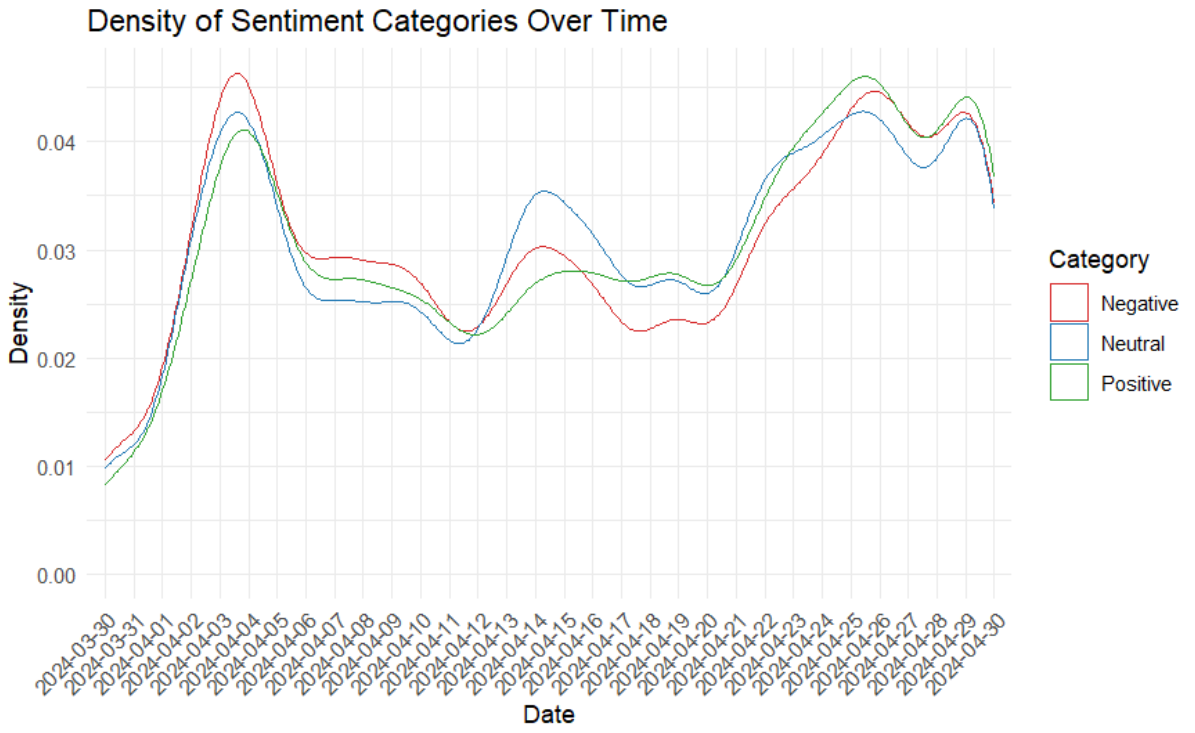



Figure 5: Density plot of sentiment category between 30th March to 30th April

## 4 Discussion and Limitations

The residual biases that might affect my findings are not considered and handled. For instance, the demographic of Reddit users might not fully represent the general population. This could cause multicollinearity problems in linear regression, where the independence assumption on predictor variables is violated.

Also, one limitation in our data collection process is that we were unable to access data older than a month or set specific date ranges. Consequently, we might miss identifying critical pivot points with significant peaks related to major events, such as the abrupt changes that occurred just before and after October 27th, coinciding with the full invasion of Israel.

Throughout this paper, we focused on using a unigram approach. However, considering a bigram approach in future analyses could offer richer information, as it captures relationships between pairs of words, potentially providing deeper insights into the data.

Additionally, a major critique of the sentiment analysis method applied here is that it fails to adjust sentiment scores for the presence of valence shifters, such as negators. One way to address this would be by using a more nuanced approach with the "sentiment" function from the "sentimetr" package. However, this method demands well-punctuated data, which is often not the case with online comments. In the absence of punctuation, texts are treated as continuous blocks, which can greatly affect the accuracy of sentiment analyses. For instance, negations, which frequently rely on punctuation to clarify their scope, might be misunderstood. A sentence like "I am not happy, but I'm not sad either" could be misinterpreted if punctuation is removed.

The latent topics identified using LDA do not exhibit significant distinctions, which may be due to inadequate text cleaning. To improve the semantic analysis, considering methodologies like Word2Vec or GloVe with cosine similarities could be beneficial, as these models might capture semantic meaning between words more effectively. Also, our method for predicting geopolitical stances may be overly simplistic, given the complexity of the topic which requires a thorough consideration of multiple factors. This complex issue may not be fully captured through basic sentiment and topic modelling techniques alone.

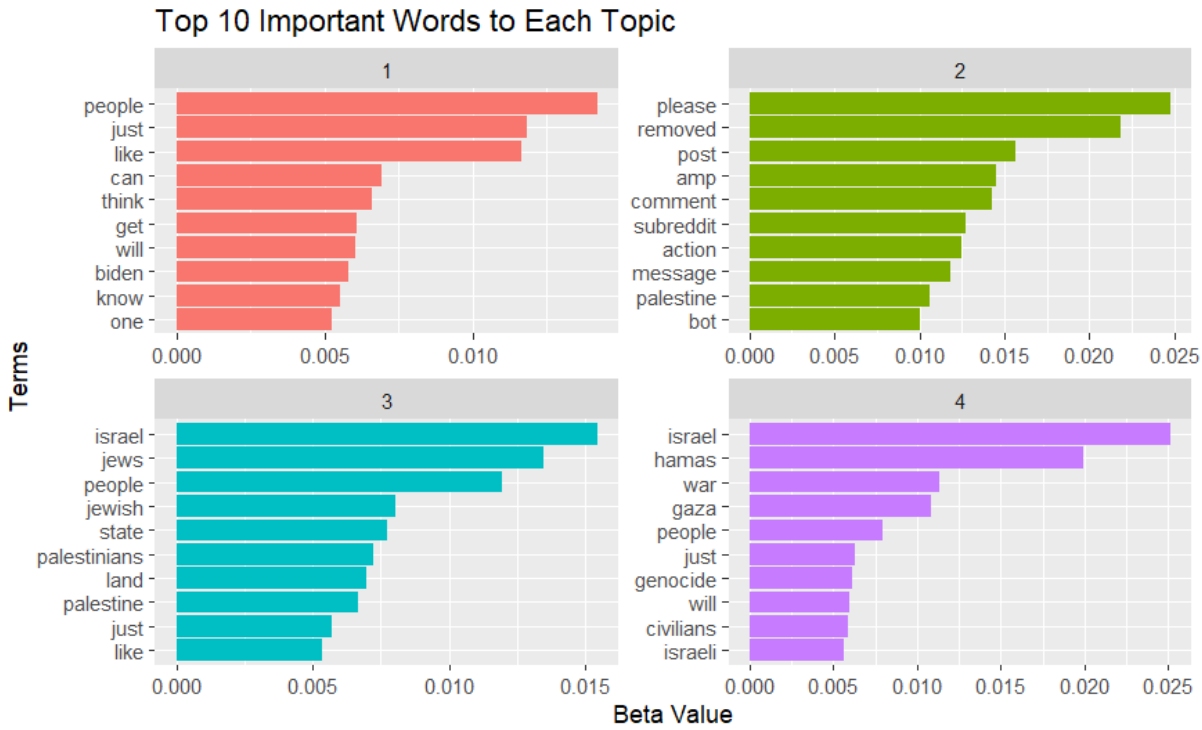



Figure 6: The most important words for each topic revealed

## 5 Conclusions

By analyzing comments from Reddit users on the Palestine/Israel conflict across various subreddits, we were able to examine differences in lexical diversity, such as the Type-Token Ratio (TTR) and readability scores. Our regression analysis showed that while readability and TTR do not significantly influence the upvotes received by comments, the specific subreddit community does. We also highlighted the most frequent terms in these comments, weighted by upvotes. Using sentiment analysis with a Twitter lexicon, we observed a sensible distribution of sentiment scores and noted interesting variations in sentiment density over time, correlating with major real-world events. Additionally, through topic modelling, we identified latent topics that cluster together. We naively predicted geopolitical stances by combining results from Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA) and sentiment scores, providing a preliminary insight into the community's perspectives.

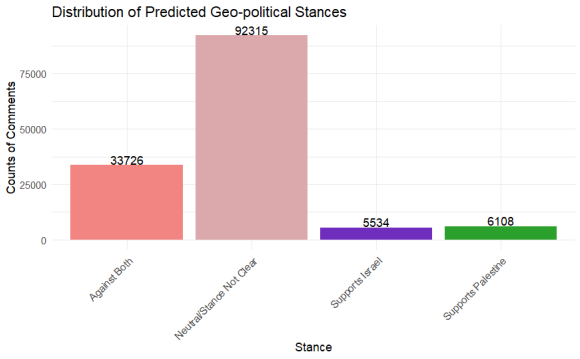



Figure 7: Bar plot of predicted geo-political stances

To gain deeper insights into this topic in the future, conducting a comparative analysis that includes data from various social media platforms could prove to be valuable. This approach would provide a broader perspective and enhance the understanding of the subject by comparing different sets of user interactions and responses across platforms. Consider other methods and approaches by integrating the limitations mentioned will also be valuable to do.

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# A Examples of comments with extreme sentiment scores

| Comment | Cleaned Comment | Sentiment Score | Subreddit |
|---|---|---|---|
| Yes what they need to do is just find a way to have them go one by one. Set up a refugee camp that they have no chance of getting to on foot as a group, and then taxi them over one by one. You could vette them and start the interactions with them isolated. The Hamas and Islam Cult like environment means that they all feel pressured to act a certain way, or in some cases to not act the way they should. The real truth is they need to be separated into small groups one at a time as fast as possible, and given some tests and interviews to test their extremism. If they arent in a group then we are more likely to see the good ones express themselves. You could have them recite against Hamas... | Yes what they need to do is just find a way to have them go one by one Set up a refugee camp that they have no chance of getting to on foot as a group and then taxi them over one by one You could vette them and start the interactions with them isolated The Hamas and Islam Cult like environment means that they all feel pressured to act a certain way or in some cases to not act the way they should The real truth is they need to be separated into small groups one at a time as fast as possible and given some tests and interviews to test their extremism If they arent in a group then we are more likely to see the good ones express themselves You could have them recite against Hamas ... | 21.90 | Others |
| My values are already popular. They are consistently supported by the electorate and are popular electoral talking points for candidates until they challenge neoliberal hegemony.<br>- Equal rights across racial, gendered, sexual, age demographics<br>- Bodily autonomy<br>- Equality under the law regarding racial disparity<br>- Limitation on capitalistic overreach regarding product standards, waste, production, and corporations legal standings and permisssions<br>- Anti-war<br>- Anti-genocide ... | My values are already popular They are consistently supported by the electorate and are popular electoral talking points for candidates until they challenge neoliberal hegemony<br>Equal rights across racial gendered sexual age demographics<br>Bodily autonomy<br>Equality under the law regarding racial disparity<br>Limitation on capitalistic overreach regarding product standards waste production and corporations legal standings and permisssions<br>Antiwar<br>Antigenocide ... | 20.5 | Others |
| Where do you live? The reform synagogues in my area proudly have the Israeli Flag out and during the last shabbat service the reform rabbi was wearing the bring them home dog tag. It seems like you live in a very left wing area?<br>And in terms of conservative and orthodox keep these 2 things in mind:<br>1. there are people that are anti-Zionists that identify with the conservative movement . There are rabbis part of [https://truah.org/](https://truah.org/) 2. Lets not forget about the orthodox sects that range from either being anti-Zionists (like the satmars) or non-Zionists ... | Where do you live The reform synagogues in my area proudly have the Israeli Flag out and during the last shabbat service the reform rabbi was wearing the bring them home dog tag It seems like you live in a very left wing area<br>And in terms of conservative and orthodox keep these things in mind<br>there are people that are antiZionists ... | 19.65 | r/Israel |

Table 4: Example of extreme positive comments

| Comment | Cleaned Comment | Sentiment Score | Subreddit |
|---|---|---|---|
| gt;But then 7 western aid workers were deliberately struck<br>So far, there is no proof it was deliberate and the IDF is investigating and said they will do so transparently. Facts don't come out immediately, they take time. Something that most people don't have patience for.<br>gt;Even the Jewish Council Australia is condemning the IDF.<br>Condemning or criticizing. The IDF is not immune to criticism and legit criticism is not a problem. Like this case where, clearly something went wrong. Israelis criticize the IDF all the time.<br>gt;Why is it when Israel deliberately kills a non-combatant, it's an "accident", but when Hamas deliberately kills a non-combatant, it is "deliberate"? ... | gtBut then western aid workers were deliberately struck<br>So far there is no proof it was deliberate and the IDF is investigating and said they will do so transparently Facts dont come out immediately they take time Something that most people dont have patience for<br>gtEven the Jewish Council Australia is condemning the IDF<br>Condemning or criticizing The IDF is not immune to criticism and legit criticism is not a problem Like this case where clearly something went wrong Israelis criticize the IDF all the time<br>gtWhy is it when Israel deliberately kills a noncombatant its an accident but when Hamas deliberately kills a noncombatant it is deliberate ... | -71 | Others |
| gt;You are literally comparing a trained IDF soldier to a disenfranchised, untrained, uneducated Terrorist, and yet you excuse the IDF soldier's actions as "mistakes" and claim a disenfranchised, untrained, uneducated Terrorist has more accurate target acquisition protocols than a trained IDF soldier.<br>For someone that claims to be knowledgeable about the conflict you sure don't show it. Hamas terrorist are not untrained. Hamas receives billions of dollars of funding from Qatar and they use that funding to train and educate their military on how to kill Jews. We also have video footage of Hamas soldiers deliberately murdering civilians and taking hostages. Stop infantilizing terrorists. Hamas terrorists are full grown educated adults they have full responsibility over their actions ... | gtYou are literally comparing a trained IDF soldier to a disenfranchised untrained uneducated Terrorist and yet you excuse the IDF soldiers actions as mistakes and claim a disenfranchised untrained uneducated Terrorist has more accurate target acquisition protocols than a trained IDF soldier<br>For someone that claims to be knowledgeable about the conflict you sure dont show it Hamas terrorist are not untrained Hamas receives billions of dollars of funding from Qatar and they use that funding to train and educate their military on how to kill Jews We also have video footage of Hamas soldiers deliberately murdering civilians and taking hostages Stop infantilizing terrorists Hamas terrorists are full grown educated adults they have full responsibility over their actions ... | -96 | Others |
| gt;Do you really believe there is no moral equivalency between shooting dead 3 naked, Israeli hostages holding white flags, and shooting residents of a Kibbutz?<br>Of course I believe that. The soldiers who shot these Israeli hostages assumed it's some kind of Hamas ruse. There's no reason to assume these Israeli soldiers simply wanted to murder Israeli civilians, because they hate Israelis ... | gtDo you really believe there is no moral equivalency between shooting dead naked Israeli hostages holding white flags and shooting residents of a Kibbutz<br>Of course I believe that The soldiers who shot these Israeli hostages assumed its some kind of Hamas ruse Theres no reason to assume these Israeli soldiers simply wanted to murder Israeli civilians because they hate Israelis ... | -87 | Others |

Table 5: Example of extreme negative comments